

Working assumptions, not forecasts. Capacity figures are scaled from a single Dutch reference case. Legal and regulatory entries were researched in September 2026, are not yet verified against primary sources, and will date. Generated 2026-09-05. [How this was built.](#)

France

Sovereign government data centre network — capacity, legal posture, provider landscape and migration path.

1 Starting point

Population	68.88 m
GDP	EUR 2,991 bn
Public administration (NACE O)	2,272 k
Electricity price	153.4 EUR/MWh
Renewables	31.3%
Live hyperscaler regions	4

2 What is structurally different

- Dense hyperscaler presence (4 live regions). Commercial capacity, fibre and skills exist in-country; the sovereign core can stay lean and the hybrid model works as designed. The risk is the opposite one: political pressure to declare a hyperscaler region 'sovereign enough' (Dutch GOAL.md section 17: location is not sovereignty).

3 Capacity

Servers	18,871 (CPU 13,090 / GPU 840 / storage 4,941)
IT critical load	30.6 MW
Facility design load	46.0 MW
Sites	4 (by capacity 4, floor 4)
Average per site	11.5 MW
Site count set by	capacity
CAPEX	EUR 1.09 bn
OPEX	EUR 100 m / yr

4 Proposed geography

Region	Role	Share	MW	Notes
Ile-de-France	Primary civil cloud	36%	16.6	DINUM/ministry estate, France-IX; RTE saturation - use designated turnkey sites.
Auvergne-Rhone-Alpes / Lyon	Sovereign secondary	18%	8.3	Second metro, nuclear/hydro grid, Alpine seismic zoning.
Sud-Ouest / Toulouse - Bordeaux	Defense / industrial	18%	8.3	Defense-aerospace cluster, Atlantic cable landings (Amitie).

Region	Role	Share	MW	Notes
Ouest / Rennes - Nantes	Government / continuity	18%	8.3	DGA cyber cluster (Rennes), Brittany cable landings.
Grand Est - Hauts-de-France	Strategic reserve	10%	4.6	Nuclear grid headroom; reserve/expansion.

First-pass geographic hypotheses encoding only the obvious constraints, to be replaced by scored site selection.

5 Legal and regulatory posture

Governing instrument	Doctrine 'Cloud au centre' (DINUM, revised 2023): sovereign-qualified cloud required for sensitive state data
Cloud certification	SecNumCloud (ANSSI) qualification; the most demanding national scheme in the EU-27
Data classification	IGI 1300: Secret / Tres Secret; 'Diffusion Restreinte' is a protection marking, not a classification level
Procurement route	UGAP and DINUM interministerial frameworks

Foreign jurisdiction exposure. Bleu (Microsoft) and S3NS (Google) trusted-cloud joint ventures under French control; native AWS/Azure/GCP regions excluded from sensitive workloads

Under the US CLOUD Act and FISA 702 a provider subject to US jurisdiction can face a lawful order for data it holds regardless of where that data sits. Residency is necessary but not sufficient; what matters is who holds the keys and who can be compelled.

6 Current state and provider landscape

Government cloud	SecNumCloud (ANSSI) / Cloud de confiance doctrine: OVHcloud Outscale Cloud Temple Thales S3NS qualified; Bleu and NumSpot pending (2026); state clouds Nubo (Finance) and Cloud Pi Native (Interior) via DINUM
Maturity	federated
Digital identity	FranceConnect / FranceConnect+ + France Identite
Interconnection	France-IX Paris/Marseille; Marseille Mediterranean gateway; Atlantic landings Vendee/Bordeaux/Brittany

7 Migration path and cost

Phase	Scope	MW	CAPEX	Cumulative	Hybrid
1	Sovereign core	11.7	EUR 224 m	21%	no
2	Security and defense	15.3	EUR 372 m	55%	no
3	State record	7.9	EUR 200 m	73%	no
4	Elective	11.0	EUR 291 m	100%	yes

Phase 1 is the number that matters: **EUR 224 m** for 11.7 MW, 21% of total CAPEX. That is the floor below which no hybrid arrangement helps — and it is a small fraction of the full build.

8 Geography and threat notes

Low seismic (Alps/Pyrenees moderate); Seine/Rhone flood plains; land plentiful outside Ile-de-France; RTE grid saturation Paris/Marseille (state designated turnkey DC sites 2025); nuclear gives low import dependence; terrorism/cyber main threats